

Chapter 13

Questions

Three days passed.

Elara returned to the office on Monday morning.

Everything looked normal.

The same busy hallways.

The same meetings.

The same employees moving from one room to another.

But Elara didn't feel normal anymore.

She placed her bag on the desk and stood near the window.

Her thoughts kept returning to Roman.

His message.

The rooftop.

His words.

And everything she still couldn't understand.

Her phone vibrated.

Daniel:

Are you alive?

A second message appeared.

Daniel:

Because I was about to report you missing.

A small smile appeared on Elara's face.

She replied:

Elara:

Are you home?

Daniel:

Yes. Why?

Elara:

Can I come over?

That evening...

Elara arrived at Daniel's apartment.

He opened the door and immediately noticed the seriousness on her face.

"Come in."

She stepped inside.

Daniel closed the door behind her.

Elara sat on the sofa.

Daniel sat across from her.

For a few seconds...

neither spoke.

Then Elara finally said,

"Daniel..."

"Hmm?"

"Ethan told you about Roman, right?"

Daniel nodded.

"Yes."

"He told you he's alive?"

"Yes."

Elara looked down.

"And that he's the owner of Veyron now?"

Daniel nodded again.

"He told me Roman is running Veyron now."

Elara remained silent.

Daniel looked at her.

"Why?"

She took a slow breath.

"Because now I'm going to work with him."

Daniel's expression became serious.

"I know."

Elara looked at him.

"I don't know whether I should trust Ethan anymore."

Daniel didn't interrupt.

"He was always there for me."

"He was the first person who came to me in the hospital."

"He was the first person who told me Roman was dead."

Her voice became quieter.

"I trusted him completely."

"But now..."

She looked away.

"I don't know what to believe."

Daniel leaned forward slightly.

"Elara, you don't have to decide everything today."

"I know."

She took a breath.

"But that night..."

Her voice became softer.

"That night at the library..."

"I remember Roman being there."

Daniel listened carefully.

"After that, nothing."

"I know I was in an accident."

"I know I forgot things."

She looked down at her hands.

"But Roman said something important to me that night."

"I just can't remember what it was."

Daniel frowned.

"Are you sure?"

Elara nodded.

"Yes."

"Sometimes I feel like I'm standing right next to the memory..."

"But I still can't reach it."

Daniel remained silent.

Elara looked at him.

"I don't even know why he was there."

"Or what he wanted to tell me."

Daniel slowly nodded.

"Then maybe that's where you should start."

Elara looked confused.

"Start with what?"

"With what you remember."

She shook her head.

"I barely remember anything."

"Then don't try to remember everything at once."

Daniel paused.

"Think about the smallest details."

"The library."

"Who was there."

"What Roman said."

"What happened before the accident."

Elara stared at him.

For a moment...

she said nothing.

Then quietly,

"I remember his voice."

Daniel waited.

"I remember him standing in front of me."

"And I remember being angry."

"Really angry."

She closed her eyes.

"But after that..."

"Nothing."

Daniel nodded.

"Maybe your mind blocked something because it was too much."

Elara opened her eyes.

"Maybe."

She stood and picked up her bag.

Daniel looked at her.

"You're going back to work tomorrow?"

"Yes."

"With Roman?"

Elara hesitated.

"Maybe."

Daniel raised an eyebrow.

"Maybe?"

"I don't know yet."

She walked toward the door.

Daniel followed her.
Before she left, he said,
"Whatever you decide..."
"Don't let anyone decide it for you."
Elara looked at him.
For a second, his words stayed with her.
Then she nodded.
"I won't."
She opened the door.
"Goodnight, Daniel."
"Goodnight."
Elara walked toward the elevator.
But before the doors closed...
she stopped.
Her mind suddenly returned to one small detail.
Roman's voice.
His expression.
And the feeling that whatever he had said that night...
had mattered.
Very much.
The elevator doors closed.
And Elara stood alone inside.
She looked at her reflection in the metal doors.
For the first time since the accident...
she wanted to remember.
Not because anyone had asked her to.
But because she needed to know what had really happened.

The next morning...
Elara woke up earlier than usual.
She hadn't slept well.
Daniel's words kept returning to her mind.
Don't let anyone decide it for you.
She got ready for work and left home.

When she reached Northbridge Group...
everything looked normal.

Employees moved through the hallways.

Phones rang.

Meetings were being scheduled.

Elara walked toward her office.

Emma followed her with a tablet.

"Good morning, Miss Elara."

"Good morning."

"You have a meeting at eleven."

"With whom?"

"Veyron Group."

Elara paused for a moment.

Then nodded.

"Alright."

She entered her office.

Placed her bag on the desk.

And took a slow breath.

"It's just work."

She whispered to herself.

"Nothing else."

The meeting was short.

No personal conversations.

No unnecessary questions.

Just business.

Roman arrived with two members of his team.

Elara remained professional throughout the meeting.

She didn't stare at him.

She didn't avoid him either.

She simply treated him like any other business partner.

When the meeting ended...

Roman gathered his papers.

"Thank you for your time."

Elara nodded.

"You're welcome."

He left.

Elara watched the door close.

For a few seconds...

she remained silent.

Then she returned to her work.

That evening...

Northbridge residence was filled with warm lights.

Her father had arranged a small dinner to celebrate the approval of the new project.

Nothing too formal.

Just family, close friends and a few people from both companies.

Elara entered the room.

The first person she noticed was Daniel.

He was standing near the dining table.

Holding a plate.

And arguing with Ava.

"I'm telling you..."

"That cake was mine."

Ava stared at him.

"You ate half of it."

"Exactly."

"So why are you calling it yours?"

"Because I was protecting it."

Elara laughed.

"Daniel..."

He turned around.

"Elara!"

He walked toward her.

"Please explain to her that I'm right."

"You're not."

Daniel looked offended.

"I trusted you."

"You shouldn't have."

Ava laughed.

Daniel shook his head.

"This friendship is toxic."

Elara smiled.

"Then leave."

"I can't."

"Why?"

"Because the food is too good."

Elara laughed again.

For a moment...

she forgot everything.

A few minutes later...

the rest of the group joined them.

Everyone was talking.

Laughing.

Arguing over old stories.

Daniel started telling a story about something Ethan had done years ago.

Ethan immediately interrupted him.

"Don't."

Daniel grinned.

"Why?"

"Because you promised."

"I promised nothing."

"You promised me."

"That was before I remembered the story."

Everyone laughed.

Elara looked at Ethan.

For the first time that evening...

she noticed something.

He wasn't laughing as much as the others.

He seemed distracted.

She watched him for a moment.

Then looked away.
Maybe she was imagining things.

Later...
Elara stepped into the hallway for some quiet.
She stopped near the large window.
Outside...
the garden lights reflected against the glass.
She heard footsteps behind her.
She turned.
Roman.
He stopped a few steps away.
Neither said anything at first.
Then Roman spoke.
"You're quieter than usual."
Elara looked at him.
"I'm just tired."
"Fair enough."
He nodded.
Then his phone rang.
Roman looked at the screen.
His expression changed slightly.
He answered.
"Hello?"
Elara wasn't trying to listen.
But she noticed his expression becoming serious.
"Where?"
A pause.
"Don't tell anyone yet."
Another pause.
"I'll handle it."
He ended the call.
Elara looked at him.
"Is everything okay?"

Roman looked at her.

"Not really."

"What happened?"

"I can't discuss it here."

Elara nodded.

"Then forget I asked."

Roman looked at her for a moment.

"You still ask questions even when you know you might not like the answer."

Elara's expression became serious.

"Maybe I'm finally learning."

Roman didn't reply.

He simply nodded.

Then walked away.

Elara watched him leave.

Something had clearly happened.

But she didn't know what.

And for some reason...

she had a feeling it was going to affect all of them.